

INTERRUPT



FREE OVERVIEW

The Method, Explained.

Why 12 specific visual patterns stop a scroll faster than anything else you could put in frame one - the psychology, the taxonomy, and the AI prompt formula behind every one of them.

[START HERE](#)

What This Is

This is the free overview of **INTERRUPT: The Pattern Interrupt Method** - a named system of 12 visual techniques that make a viewer's brain stop, in the first 0.8 seconds, before they've decided to scroll past you.

This edition covers the full psychology and the complete taxonomy, with one working AI prompt per technique so you can start using it today. The paid edition, **INTERRUPT: The Complete System**, expands every technique into 15–25 ready-to-paste prompt variations, plus a decision framework for choosing the right interrupt for any content goal.

DONE-FOR-YOU OPTION**Reading This to Do It Yourself? Fair. There's Also a Faster Way.**

Everything past this page teaches you the method. If you'd rather skip straight to results, we also run this system on your handles directly - see the last page, or just email denorgerald@gmail.com now.

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PART 0 - The Psychology (Why Interrupters Work)

Every pattern interrupt does one of three things to the brain in the first 0.8 seconds:

1. **Reality violation** - the brain detects "that shouldn't be possible" and stops to resolve the error. (Surreal physics, impossible objects, material swaps.)
2. **Signal salience** - something is so visually loud, novel, or emotionally charged it overrides the autopilot scroll. (Glitch, neon, extreme contrast, a face in distress.)
3. **Open loop / incomplete information** - the brain is handed a puzzle it must close. (A door opening to something unknown, a mask cracking, an interrupted motion.)

All three hijack the same mechanism the HOOK_GUIDE defines: **Pattern Interrupt (0-0.8s) → Identity Signal (0.8-1.5s) → Open Loop (1.5-3s)**.

The interrupt is *only the first frame*. It buys you 3 seconds. The hook architecture then has to deliver.

PART 1 - The 12 Categories & Named Techniques

CATEGORY 1: GRAVITY & PHYSICS BREAKS

The brain's most primal expectation is that things fall down. Breaking gravity is the fastest possible reality violation.

1.1 - The Float (Levitation)

WHAT IT IS A subject or object hovers in mid-air, bobbing slightly, defying gravity.

WHY IT STOPS Pure reality violation. "That's not supposed to stay up there."

AI prompt

A [object/person] floats in mid-air, gently bobbing and rotating slowly, with no visible support, against [a clean/blurred background]. Subtle weightless drift, soft realistic lighting and shadow below showing it is suspended. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID strings, wires, visible hand, falling, resting on a surface, gravity, ground contact.

1.2 - The Fall (Falling Through Frame)

WHAT IT IS A character enters from the top and falls straight down, limbs moving naturally, exiting the bottom. (This is the example you were shown.)

WHY IT STOPS The motion is continuous and un-ignorable; the brain tracks the fall.

AI prompt

A [character] enters from the top of the frame and falls straight down through the center until they exit at the bottom. While falling, they move arms and legs in continuous natural motion - arms bend, hands shift, legs softly kick. Keep the movement visible but subtle, fluid, realistic. Static [background description]. Locked camera, no zoom, pan, tilt, or rotation. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID frozen limbs, rigid pose, standing, walking, floating upright, floor, ground, portal, extra limbs, distorted anatomy, CGI artifacts.

1.3 - Reverse Gravity (Things Fall Up)

WHAT IT IS Objects rise instead of falling - rain falling upward, hair defying gravity, a person walking on the ceiling.

WHY IT STOPS A direct inversion of the most basic physics expectation.

AI prompt

Reverse gravity effect: [liquid/rain/objects/hair] rises upward instead of falling, defying gravity in a dreamlike but physically-lit scene. The subject [moves normally] while the world's gravity is inverted around them. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID normal falling, gravity, downward motion, realistic physics.

1.4 - Zero-G / Weightlessness

WHAT IT IS Everything in the frame floats - a room of suspended objects, a person drifting like in space.

WHY IT STOPS Multiple simultaneous reality violations are more arresting than one.

AI prompt

Zero-gravity scene: [a person and surrounding objects] float weightlessly, drifting slowly and colliding softly, hair and fabric suspended, in a [room/environment]. Soft volumetric light, dust motes floating. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID gravity, objects resting on surfaces, falling, grounded, normal physics.

1.5 - The Ground Opens (Falling Into a Hole / Portal)

WHAT IT IS The floor opens beneath the subject, who falls backward into a hole that wasn't there.

WHY IT STOPS The ground is the most "safe" surface - violating it is deeply destabilizing.

AI prompt

Frame stays static while a character takes a step backward as a [dark hole/portal] opens in the ground behind them and they fall backward into it, feet last. Camera position stays fixed, no zoom or pan. The hole glows faintly at its edges. 9:16.

AVOID character walking forward, staying on ground, hole closing, camera movement, jumping, levitating.

CATEGORY 2: SCALE & PROPORTION DISTORTION

2.1 - Giant Object / Tiny Subject

WHAT IT IS A normal object is impossibly huge, or the subject is impossibly small.

WHY IT STOPS The brain instantly registers the scale mismatch as "wrong."

AI prompt

A [tiny person] stands next to a [gigantic normal object, e.g., a strawberry the size of a house], emphasizing extreme scale contrast. Photorealistic, soft lighting, shallow depth of field. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID normal scale, proportional objects, flat, miniature without context.

2.2 - Shrink / Grow

WHAT IT IS The subject or object continuously shrinks or grows within a single shot.

WHY IT STOPS Continuous, impossible scale change forces the eye to track it.

AI prompt

A [person/object] continuously [shrinks/grows] in real time while the background stays constant, creating an impossible scale shift. Smooth, gradual, physically lit. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID static size, sudden jumps, camera zoom (the scale change must be on the subject, not the camera).

2.3 - Extreme Zoom (Macro to Cosmic)

WHAT IT IS The camera zooms impossibly far - from a seed into its cells, or from a face out to the galaxy.

WHY IT STOPS The journey through scale is hypnotic and disorienting.

AI prompt

An impossible continuous zoom: start at [a tiny detail, e.g., a seed] and pull back continuously through [increasingly large scales] until reaching [a cosmic scale, e.g., the whole planet]. Seamless, no cuts, smooth motion. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID jump cuts, jerky zoom, static framing, breaks in continuity.

2.4 - Miniature World (Tilt-Shift / Toy Effect)

WHAT IT IS A real scene rendered as if it's a tiny toy model.

WHY IT STOPS Familiar scenes look suddenly "fake" and cute - a curiosity hook.

AI prompt

Tilt-shift miniature effect: [a real scene, e.g., a farm, a city street] rendered as a tiny, hyper-detailed toy model. Shallow depth of field, exaggerated saturation, everything looks like a miniature diorama. Locked camera, 9:16.

AVOID normal depth of field, realistic scale, full-size realism.

CATEGORY 3: TIME MANIPULATION

3.1 - Time Freeze (One Moving Element)

WHAT IT IS The whole world is frozen - water suspended, people mid-motion - except ONE element that still moves.

WHY IT STOPS The contrast between frozen and moving is hypnotic and creates an instant "how is this happening" open loop.

AI prompt

Time-freeze effect: the entire scene is frozen - [water droplets suspended in air, people mid-motion, objects floating] - except a single [hand/person/object] that moves normally through the frozen world. Sharp contrast between motion and stillness. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID everything moving, nothing frozen, blurry motion, normal time.

3.2 - Time Reversal (Un-Growing / Rewind)

WHAT IT IS Action runs backward - a leaf folds back into a bud, water flows upward into a glass, a flower un-blooms.

WHY IT STOPS Reversed motion of a recognizable process is deeply disorienting.

AI prompt

Reverse-time effect: [a recognizable process, e.g., a flower blooming, water pouring, a building collapsing] plays in reverse - [the flower folds back into a bud, water flows upward into the glass]. Smooth, physically realistic lighting, no indication of it being played backward. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID normal forward motion, obvious rewind artifacts, jerky reversal.

3.3 - Hyper Slow-Mo (Ultra Detail)

WHAT IT IS A fast, chaotic moment - a splash, a shatter, a burst - slowed to a crawl, revealing detail invisible to the naked eye.

WHY IT STOPS Novelty. The brain has never *seen* these moments clearly before.

AI prompt

Ultra slow-motion: [a fast event, e.g., a water balloon bursting, a pepper being sliced, seeds scattering] at extreme slow motion, every droplet and fragment crisp and detailed. High-speed-camera aesthetic, sharp focus, dramatic lighting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID normal speed, motion blur, low detail, unclear subject.

3.4 - Time-Lapse Rush

WHAT IT IS A slow process - a plant growing, a day passing - compressed into seconds.

WHY IT STOPS Seeing a "hidden" process (growth, transformation) feels like privileged knowledge.

AI prompt

Time-lapse: [a slow natural process, e.g., a seed sprouting into a full plant, a sunrise-to-sunset] compressed into a few seconds, with smooth continuous growth and changing light. Seamless, no jumps. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID jump cuts, static growth, same lighting throughout, broken continuity.

3.5 - Perfect Loop (Infinite Motion)

WHAT IT IS The motion loops seamlessly so the viewer can't find the start or end - hypnotic.

WHY IT STOPS The brain tries to find the seam and fails, staying to figure it out.

AI prompt

Seamless infinite loop: [a continuous motion, e.g., a ball rolling through a maze, a hand repeatedly tossing and catching, a spinning object] that loops perfectly with no visible start or end point. The first and last frame are identical. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID visible loop seam, changing position between loops, breaks in motion.

CATEGORY 4: GLITCH & DIGITAL CORRUPTION

4.1 - Glitch / Scanline Corruption

WHAT IT IS The image tears, distorts, and corrupts with digital glitch artifacts.

WHY IT STOPS A sudden "broken screen" is a high-salience signal - the brain checks if the device is breaking.

AI prompt

Digital glitch effect: [a subject/action] becomes corrupted by [glitch artifacts, RGB split, scanlines, pixel displacement], as if the video signal is breaking down, then momentarily recovers. Cyberpunk or VHS glitch aesthetic. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID clean image, no distortion, smooth motion, static glitch throughout.

4.2 - Pixel Dissolve (Matter Becomes Pixels)

WHAT IT IS A subject or object disintegrates into pixels, particles, or digital dust and reassembles.

WHY IT STOPS The "matter → data" transformation is a clean, satisfying visual magic trick.

AI prompt

Pixel-dissolve effect: a [person/object] disintegrates into [glowing pixels/digital particles] that drift apart, then reassembles back into solid form. Smooth transition, futuristic clean aesthetic. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID hard cut, no transition, disappearing without particles, smoke instead of pixels.

4.3 - VHS / Screen Tear

WHAT IT IS The video looks like degraded VHS tape - tracking errors, color bleed, horizontal tearing.

WHY IT STOPS Retro-degradation stands out against clean, modern feeds.

AI prompt

VHS tape aesthetic: [a subject/action] shot as degraded analog video - horizontal tracking errors, color bleed, scanlines, grain, occasional signal loss. Warm retro color cast. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID clean digital, modern clarity, no grain, stable image.

4.4 - Liquify / Melt

WHAT IT IS The subject or background melts, drips, or warps like liquid.

WHY IT STOPS A stable object becoming fluid is a clean reality violation.

AI prompt

Liquify effect: [a subject/object] begins to melt and drip downward like [water/paint/honey], warping and distorting while retaining recognizable features. Surreal, smooth, glossy liquid lighting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID solid form, rigid, no distortion, frozen, dry texture.

4.5 - Data-Mosh / Compression Artifact

WHAT IT IS Motion causes blocks of the image to smear and lag, like a corrupted video file.

WHY IT STOPS It looks "broken" - the brain investigates the error.

AI prompt

Data-mosh effect: when [the subject moves], blocks of the image smear, lag, and distort, creating a corrupted-compression aesthetic, as if the video file is failing. Saturated colors, digital artifacts. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID clean motion, no artifacts, stable pixels, smooth footage.

CATEGORY 5: MATERIAL & TEXTURE SWAPS

5.1 - Sand / Water / Smoke Person (Material Morph)

WHAT IT IS The subject is made of - or dissolves into - an unexpected material (sand, water, smoke, fire, liquid metal).

WHY IT STOPS A human form in a non-human material is a strong, memorable reality violation.

AI prompt

A [person] is made of / dissolves into [flowing sand / clear water / drifting smoke / liquid metal]. The material behaves realistically - [the sand pours, the water ripples, the smoke drifts], while the human silhouette remains recognizable. Dramatic lighting, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID solid flesh, rigid material, no particle motion, static texture.

5.2 - Paper Collage / Mixed-Media Cutout

WHAT IT IS The subject is a cut-out paper collage over a textured background, moving with subtle stop-motion. (This is the "Falling 1" style from your example.)

WHY IT STOPS The handmade, analog texture is a jarring contrast to glossy AI/CGI feeds.

AI prompt

Mixed-media paper collage: a [subject] is a recognizable full-color cutout with a thin, uneven white paper border, moving with subtle natural motion over a static [collage background of torn paper, photocopy textures, clouds, grain]. Analog zine imperfections, soft shadows between layers, 9:16 vertical. Locked camera.

AVOID CGI, glossy 3D, clean vector, realistic person, no paper texture, text, watermark.

5.3 - 3D-to-2D Flatten

WHAT IT IS A 3D subject collapses into a flat 2D shape (or vice versa), like a pop-up book.

WHY IT STOPS The dimension switch is a clean, satisfying "how did that happen" moment.

AI prompt

A [3D subject] smoothly flattens into a [2D flat illustration / paper cutout / silhouette], then unfolds back to 3D. The transition is seamless, the 2D and 3D versions match perfectly. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID hard cut, mismatched forms, no transition, both states identical.

5.4 - Glass / Ice / Crystal

WHAT IT IS The subject is translucent glass or crystalline ice, catching and refracting light.

WHY IT STOPS Translucency and refraction are visually novel and "expensive-looking."

AI prompt

A [subject] made of [clear glass / ice / crystal], translucent and refracting light, with internal reflections and subtle refractions. Slowly rotates or performs a small motion. Clean studio lighting, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID opaque, solid, no refraction, dull material, no light interaction.

5.5 - Particle Dissolve (Leaves / Dust / Sparkles)

WHAT IT IS The subject bursts into leaves, petals, dust, or sparkles and reforms.

WHY IT STOPS Satisfying, magical, and visually "shareable."

AI prompt

A [subject/object] bursts into [thousands of leaves / flower petals / glowing dust particles] that scatter and swirl, then converge back and reform into the solid form. Smooth, cinematic, warm lighting, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID hard cut, smoke instead of particles, no reassembly, disappearing permanently.

5.6 - Claymation / Stop-Motion

WHAT IT IS The whole scene is rendered as plasticine/clay with visible fingerprints and jerky stop-motion.

WHY IT STOPS The tactile, handmade aesthetic cuts through glossy content.

AI prompt

Claymation / stop-motion style: [a subject and scene] rendered as plasticine clay with visible fingerprints and imperfect handmade texture, moving in subtle stop-motion. Warm soft lighting, charming imperfections, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID smooth CGI, realistic skin, clean vector, no texture, fluid 60fps motion.

CATEGORY 6: MIRROR & SYMMETRY

6.1 - Infinite Mirror (Recursion)

WHAT IT IS The subject is reflected infinitely - a mirror reflecting a mirror reflecting a mirror.

WHY IT STOPS The infinite regression is disorienting and the brain tries to find the "end."

AI prompt

Infinite mirror recursion: [a subject stands between two mirrors / holds a mirror facing itself], creating an infinitely repeating reflection that recedes into the distance. Each reflection is a slightly smaller copy. Cinematic lighting, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID single reflection, no recursion, flat mirror, no depth.

6.2 - Reflection Mismatch (The Reflection Speaks Back)

WHAT IT IS The reflection in the mirror does something different from the subject - blinks, smiles, looks away, or moves independently.

WHY IT STOPS A subtle, creepy reality violation - the brain notices the mismatch and is unsettled.

AI prompt

A [subject] looks into a mirror, and their reflection [does something the subject does not - blinks slowly, smiles wider, looks away, or moves independently]. The subject is still while the reflection acts. Subtle, uncanny, realistic lighting, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID reflection matching subject, no mismatch, cartoonish, exaggerated.

6.3 - Kaleidoscope Symmetry

WHAT IT IS The frame becomes a kaleidoscope - radial, mirrored, trippy symmetry.

WHY IT STOPS Extreme symmetrical complexity is hypnotic and visually loud.

AI prompt

Kaleidoscope effect: [a subject/pattern] multiplied into radial mirrored symmetry, rotating slowly, creating a hypnotic repeating mandala. Vibrant colors, clean geometric precision, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID asymmetric, single image, no mirroring, flat, static.

6.4 - Split-Screen Impossible

WHAT IT IS Two halves of the frame don't align - a person's top and bottom halves from different scenes, or two people in one body.

WHY IT STOPS The misalignment creates an instant "wait, what am I looking at" moment.

AI prompt

Split-screen impossible: the top half of the frame shows [one scene/subject] and the bottom half shows [a completely different scene/subject], seamlessly joined at a clean horizontal seam so they appear to be one continuous but impossible image. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID mismatched seam, broken join, two separate videos, no continuity.

DONE-FOR-YOU OPTION

Six Categories Down, Six to Go

You're halfway through the taxonomy. If you're already thinking 'I don't have time to produce all this myself,' that's exactly what the done-for-you option solves - details at the end of this guide.

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CATEGORY 7: IMPOSSIBLE OBJECTS & SURREAL SPACE

7.1 - The Door / Portal to Somewhere Else

WHAT IT IS A door, window, or portal opens onto a scene that shouldn't be there - a beach in a bedroom, a field inside an office.

WHY IT STOPS The "door to another world" is a powerful open loop - the brain must see what's through it.

AI prompt

A [door/window/portal] opens to reveal [an impossible scene - a beach, a forest, a galaxy, another room] that cannot exist in its location. The subject [walks through / looks through]. Seamless, cinematic lighting on both sides, 9:16.

AVOID empty doorway, black void, no revealed scene, broken seam.

7.2 - Object Out of Place

WHAT IT IS A normal object appears where it categorically shouldn't - a whale in a swimming pool, a tree growing from a desk, a door in a field.

WHY IT STOPS The absurd juxtaposition is instantly attention-grabbing and shareable.

AI prompt

A [huge ordinary object, e.g., a whale / a tree / a door] appears in [a place it cannot belong, e.g., a swimming pool / an office desk / a farm field], fully photorealistic and lit consistently with the scene. Locked camera, 9:16.

AVOID object blending in, believable placement, no contrast, flat lighting.

7.3 - Impossible Architecture (Escher / Penrose)

WHAT IT IS Stairs that loop back on themselves, rooms with gravity going in two directions, M.C. Escher-style geometry.

WHY IT STOPS The brain's spatial reasoning fails and it stays to resolve the paradox.

AI prompt

Impossible architecture: [a staircase / room] in the style of M.C. Escher, where [stairs loop back onto themselves / gravity points in multiple directions]. Surreal, geometrically precise, clean lighting, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID normal architecture, possible geometry, flat, no paradox.

7.4 - Living Objects (Objects With Faces / Eyes)

WHAT IT IS Inanimate objects come alive - a coffee mug blinks, a pepper has a face and reacts.

WHY IT STOPS Anthropomorphism is cute/creepy and highly shareable (strong in food/CPG content).

AI prompt

A [normal object, e.g., a coffee mug / a pepper / a shoe] comes alive with [a simple expressive face / subtle animation], reacting to [something off-screen]. Charming, minimal, personality-driven, photorealistic or soft 3D, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID inanimate, static object, no expression, horror, overly detailed face.

CATEGORY 8: BODY & ANATOMY DISTORTION

8.1 - Duplicated Limbs / Extra Hands

WHAT IT IS The subject has extra hands, arms, or other limbs doing multiple things at once.

WHY IT STOPS Extra anatomy is a strong, slightly uncanny reality violation.

AI prompt

A [person] has [extra hands / extra arms] that move independently and naturally, all performing [a task] simultaneously. The extra limbs emerge smoothly from the body with realistic anatomy and lighting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID missing limbs, extra limbs floating, distorted anatomy, wrong number of fingers.

8.2 - Head / Body Swap

WHAT IT IS Heads on the wrong bodies, or faces swapped between two people.

WHY IT STOPS The mismatch is immediately recognizable and unsettling.

AI prompt

Body-swap effect: [a face] appears on [a completely different body / an animal / an inanimate object], moving and reacting naturally. Seamless, photorealistic, consistent lighting, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID mismatched seam, floating head, wrong proportions, visible compositing.

8.3 - Elastic / Stretchy Body

WHAT IT IS The body stretches, squashes, and deforms like rubber.

WHY IT STOPS Impossible body physics is a clean cartoon-style interrupt.

AI prompt

Elastic-body effect: a [person] stretches, squashes, and deforms like rubber, with limbs elongating and the body compressing, then snapping back to normal. Cartoon physics, smooth motion, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID rigid body, no deformation, realistic bone structure, no squash and stretch.

8.4 - Detached Body Parts

WHAT IT IS A hand floats and acts on its own, a head detaches, an eye opens where it shouldn't.

WHY IT STOPS Detachment of a body part is a primal, uncanny interrupt.

AI prompt

A [hand / head / eye] detaches from a [person] and [floats / moves / acts] independently, while the person remains otherwise normal. The detached part retains realistic anatomy and lighting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID blood, gore, horror, attached body part, no independence.

CATEGORY 9: CAMERA & PERSPECTIVE TRICKS

9.1 - Whip-Pan Reveal

WHAT IT IS The camera whips rapidly to one side to reveal something surprising.

WHY IT STOPS The sudden motion is a salience spike, and the reveal completes an open loop.

AI prompt

Whip-pan reveal: the camera whips rapidly to the [left/right], motion blurring mid-pan, and lands on [a surprising reveal]. The whip is fast and smooth, then the camera locks. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID slow pan, no motion blur, no reveal, jerky landing.

9.2 - Dutch Angle / Horizon Tilt

WHAT IT IS The frame is tilted off-axis - the horizon is at 10-30 degrees, making everything feel "off."

WHY IT STOPS A tilted world is a subtle but constant unease signal.

AI prompt

Dutch angle: the entire scene is tilted [10-30 degrees] off-axis, the horizon angled, creating a subtle feeling of unease and disorientation. [Subject/action continues normally]. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID level horizon, straight camera, balanced composition, no tilt.

9.3 - Forced Perspective

WHAT IT IS An optical illusion where scale is manipulated by angle - someone "holding" the sun, or "standing on" a tiny car.

WHY IT STOPS The illusion is a satisfying "aha" the viewer feels smart for catching.

AI prompt

Forced perspective illusion: a [person] appears to [hold / stand on / interact with] a [huge or tiny object] through clever camera angle, creating a playful optical illusion. Single locked camera angle, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID no illusion, mismatched scale, obvious trick, multiple angles.

9.4 - Dolly Zoom (Vertigo Effect)

WHAT IT IS The camera zooms in while moving back (or vice versa), making the background stretch while the subject stays the same size.

WHY IT STOPS The simultaneous zoom+move is deeply disorienting - a classic "vertigo" shot.

AI prompt

Dolly zoom (vertigo effect): the camera [zooms in while dollying back], causing the background to stretch and compress dramatically while the subject stays the same size in frame. Cinematic, disorienting, smooth, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID static background, no stretch, normal zoom, fixed perspective.

9.5 - Fourth-Wall Break

WHAT IT IS The subject stops and looks directly at the camera, breaking the illusion of being observed.

WHY IT STOPS Direct eye contact is a primal attention trigger; it feels personal.

AI prompt

Fourth-wall break: mid-[action/scene], the [subject] suddenly stops and looks directly into the camera, [speaking / gesturing] to the viewer as if aware they are being watched. Natural, candid, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID never looking at camera, unaware subject, breaking character unnaturally.

9.6 - POV-to-Reveal

WHAT IT IS The shot starts as first-person POV, then pulls back to reveal who/what you were seeing through.

WHY IT STOPS The reveal recontextualizes everything - a strong open loop.

AI prompt

POV-to-reveal: the scene starts in first-person POV [doing an action], then the camera smoothly pulls back to reveal [the actual subject / an unexpected context] that changes the meaning of what was just seen. Seamless transition, 9:16.

AVOID no reveal, staying in POV, hard cut, no recontextualization.

CATEGORY 10: EMOTION & EXPECTATION SUBVERSION

10.1 - Bait & Switch (Context Flip)

WHAT IT IS The opening sets up one thing, then the frame reveals it's something entirely different.

WHY IT STOPS The cognitive jolt of the pivot forces a re-read.

AI prompt

Bait-and-switch: the scene opens looking like [one thing, e.g., a luxury product / a romantic moment / a disaster], then a reveal shows it is actually [something completely different]. The pivot is instant and visually clear. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID no pivot, predictable reveal, muddled switch, unclear contrast.

10.2 - The Mask Crack

WHAT IT IS A smiling, composed face cracks - the mask slips, revealing real emotion underneath.

WHY IT STOPS The emotional reversal is a high-salience human signal.

AI prompt

The mask crack: a [person] holds a forced smile / calm expression, then the mask visibly cracks - their face shifts to reveal [real emotion: tears, exhaustion, anger] underneath. Raw, intimate, realistic, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID no emotional shift, static expression, cartoonish, melodramatic.

10.3 - Unexpected Reaction

WHAT IT IS The subject reacts in a surprising, disproportionate, or opposite way to a situation.

WHY IT STOPS The mismatch between stimulus and response is confusing and funny/shocking.

AI prompt

Unexpected reaction: in response to [a situation], a [person] reacts in a [completely unexpected way - deadpan calm, over-the-top joy, sudden tears]. The contrast between expectation and reaction is the hook. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID predictable reaction, muted response, no contrast, forced acting.

10.4 - Silence / Audio Cut

WHAT IT IS The sound abruptly cuts to total silence (with the clock ticking or a single ambient sound), jarring the viewer.

WHY IT STOPS Sudden silence is a strong salience drop - the brain checks if something broke.

AI prompt

Sudden silence: [a scene with normal sound/action] abruptly cuts to total silence, leaving only [a single ambient sound - a clock ticking, a breath, a hum]. The visual continues but the audio vacuum is jarring. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID continuous audio, no silence, no contrast, music filling the gap.

CATEGORY 11: LIGHT & COLOR

11.1 - Selective Color (One Element in Color, Rest B&W)

WHAT IT IS The whole scene is black-and-white except ONE element in vivid color.

WHY IT STOPS The color isolation is a clean, eye-catching contrast.

AI prompt

Selective color: the entire scene is [black-and-white / desaturated] except a single [element - a red pepper, a flower, an object] that remains in vivid, saturated color. The contrast isolates the subject. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID full color throughout, no isolation, muted colored element, everything gray.

11.2 - Neon / Dark Contrast

WHAT IT IS A dark scene with neon/glowing elements - the "dark room + glowing object" look.

WHY IT STOPS High contrast against a dark background is visually loud in a bright feed.

AI prompt

Neon contrast: a [dark / black] environment with a single [neon-glowing / luminescent element] as the focal point. Deep shadows, vibrant neon rim light, high contrast, cinematic. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID bright flat scene, no contrast, no glow, washed out, evenly lit.

11.3 - Light Leak / Flash

WHAT IT IS A burst of light or lens flare overwhelms the frame, transitioning into or out of a scene.

WHY IT STOPS A sudden flash is a hard salience spike that resets attention.

AI prompt

Light-leak transition: a burst of [warm light / lens flare / flash] floods the frame, transitioning from [one scene] into [another]. The flash is brief and smooth, like a film light leak. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID hard cut, no light, no transition, gradual fade only.

11.4 - Color Inversion

WHAT IT IS The frame inverts - colors flip to their opposites - creating a sudden "negative film" look.

WHY IT STOPS Color inversion is a jarring, unmistakable visual shift.

AI prompt

Color inversion: [a scene] suddenly inverts - colors flip to their photographic negatives - then snaps back to normal. The inversion is instant and total, momentarily disorienting. Locked camera, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID normal colors throughout, partial inversion, slow fade, no snap.

11.5 - Silhouette Reveal

WHAT IT IS The subject is a backlit silhouette against bright light, revealed only in outline.

WHY IT STOPS Silhouettes are dramatic, mysterious, and create an open loop ("who/what is this?").

AI prompt

Silhouette reveal: a [subject] appears as a dramatic backlit silhouette against [bright light - a sunset, a doorway, a window], their features hidden in darkness. The light slowly reveals detail. Cinematic, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID full lighting, visible face, no backlight, no contrast.

CATEGORY 12: TYPOGRAPHY & TEXT

12.1 - Kinetic Text Slam

WHAT IT IS Text slams onto the screen with impact - large, bold, in-your-face, timed to a beat or action.

WHY IT STOPS Big, fast, high-contrast text is un-missable even on mute.

AI prompt

Kinetic text: bold text [slams / types / pops] onto the screen in large, high-contrast lettering, timed to [a beat / an action], conveying [a short message]. The text dominates the frame. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID small text, slow text, low contrast, unreadable, no motion.

12.2 - Shatter / Glitch Text

WHAT IT IS Text appears, then shatters, glitches, or breaks apart (as in "the lie shatters").

WHY IT STOPS Text destruction is a satisfying, high-salience moment that mirrors the message.

AI prompt

Shattering text: [a word or phrase] appears on screen, then [shatters like glass / glitches / breaks apart] into fragments, visually mirroring [the message it conveys]. The shatter is sharp and dramatic. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID static text, no break, soft fade, unbroken word.

12.3 - Text-in-World (Text Interacts With the Environment)

WHAT IT IS Text is physically part of the scene - a character leans on a word, walks through letters, or the text casts real shadows.

WHY IT STOPS The integration of text and world is novel and dimensional.

AI prompt

Text-in-world: [a word or phrase] exists as a physical object in the scene - the subject [leans on / walks through / interacts with] the 3D text, which casts realistic shadows and occludes correctly. Dimensional, cinematic, 9:16 vertical.

AVOID flat overlay, no interaction, text not integrated, no shadows.

12.4 - Counting / Numbers Reveal

WHAT IT IS A number counts up/down dramatically on screen (dollar amounts, days, stats) as the reveal.

WHY IT STOPS Numbers create anticipation - the viewer waits to see the final figure.

AI prompt

Counting reveal: a [number / statistic] counts up/down rapidly on screen with [dramatic styling], revealing [a final figure], while [a subject/action] plays behind. The number is large and readable. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID static number, no count, unreadable, small text, no build-up.

12.5 - Text Morph (Word Transforms)

WHAT IT IS One word morphs into another - "you're broken" becomes "you're growing."

WHY IT STOPS The transformation is a satisfying visual metaphor and a clean open loop.

AI prompt

Text morph: the word [A] transforms smoothly into the word [B], letter by letter, on screen - [e.g., "broken" morphs into "growing"]. The transition is fluid and legible throughout. 9:16 vertical.

AVOID hard cut between words, illegible morph, no transformation, static text.

PART 2 - The AI Video Prompt Formula

Every interrupt prompt in this doc follows the same skeleton. Use this to write your own:

Reference PART 2 - The AI Video Prompt Formula

- [1. CAMERA & FRAME] - locked camera / slow push-in / whip-pan / dolly-zoom, 9:16 vertical, no unwanted motion
- [2. SUBJECT & ACTION] - who/what, and what they are doing, with the interrupt mechanism explicit (float / fall / melt / glitch / morph)
- [3. EFFECT / MECHANISM] - the named interrupt, stated plainly, with physical behavior (how the material flows, how the light refracts)
- [4. ENVIRONMENT] - background, lighting, mood, texture
- [5. STYLE / MEDIUM] - photoreal / 3D / paper collage / claymation / VHS
- [6. NEGATIVE PROMPT] - the failure modes to exclude

The single most important rule: state the interrupt *as a physical behavior*, not an abstract adjective. Write "the water flows upward into the glass" - not "surreal water." AI video models respond to verbs and physics, not vibes.

PART 3 - Universal Negative Prompt Library

Append these to any prompt to kill the most common AI failures:

Reference PART 3 - Universal Negative Prompt Library

frozen limbs, rigid pose, standing, walking normally, floating upright, normal physics, ground contact, strings, wires, visible hands, extra limbs, distorted anatomy, wrong number of fingers, mutated face, blurry subject, jump cuts, broken motion, hard cuts, camera shake, text, watermark, logo, play button, subtitles, cartoonish (unless intended), low quality, low detail, overexposed, underexposed, busy background, extra people

Quick-Reference Matrix (12 Categories)

#	Category	Core Interrupt	Best For
1	Gravity & Physics	Float, Fall, Reverse, Zero-G, Ground Opens	High-impact openers
2	Scale & Proportion	Giant, Shrink/Grow, Extreme Zoom, Miniature	Curiosity & wonder
3	Time Manipulation	Freeze, Reverse, Slow-Mo, Time-Lapse, Loop	Satisfying & hypnotic
4	Glitch & Corruption	Glitch, Pixel Dissolve, VHS, Melt, Data-Mosh	Edgy / tech brands
5	Material & Texture	Sand/Water/Smoke, Paper, 3D-to-2D, Glass, Particles, Clay	Aesthetic & artful
6	Mirror & Symmetry	Infinite Mirror, Reflection Mismatch, Kaleidoscope, Split	Uncanny & trippy
7	Impossible Objects	Door/Portal, Out-of-Place, Escher, Living Objects	Story & wonder
8	Body & Anatomy	Extra Limbs, Head Swap, Elastic, Detached Parts	Comedy & uncanny
9	Camera & Perspective	Whip-Pan, Dutch Angle, Forced Perspective, Dolly Zoom, Fourth Wall	Energy & intimacy
10	Emotion Subversion	Bait & Switch, Mask Crack, Unexpected Reaction, Silence	Relatable & emotional
11	Light & Color	Selective Color, Neon, Light Leak, Inversion, Silhouette	Mood & drama
12	Typography & Text	Kinetic Slam, Shatter, Text-in-World, Counting, Morph	Mute-proof hooks

WHAT'S NEXT

You Know the System. Now Get the Library.

You now understand why all 12 categories work and have one starter prompt for each. The **Complete System** is where this becomes a daily tool instead of a one-time read:

- 15–25 ready-to-paste prompt variations per category (200+ total), each tuned for a different subject, brand, or platform.
- A full negative-prompt cheat sheet per category, so you stop fighting AI video failure modes and start shipping first-take renders.
- A "Start Here" decision framework: your content goal, mapped directly to the interrupt category and sub-technique built for it.

THE TAKEAWAY

Nobody needs a thousand prompts. You need to understand the 12 patterns and know which one to reach for today. That's what both editions of INTERRUPT are built to give you.

Get the Complete System: [GUMROAD LINK HERE]

Prefer to hand the whole thing off? We also offer done-for-you social media management, applying the INTERRUPT method to your handles directly. Email denorgerald@gmail.com to ask.